



DATA FOR GOOD

Date: February 7, 2026

Subject: Request for information related to the Vetting of Wedding-Based Schemes (VOWS) reportedly developed or supported by Palantir Technologies, from January 1, 2025 to present.

To the USCIS FOIA Office,

Pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act, 5 U.S.C. § 552, I request records sufficient to describe the nature, purpose, and operational use of the tool known as “VOWS” (Vetting of Wedding-Based Schemes), reportedly developed or supported by Palantir Technologies and used by U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services.

This request is limited to records created or updated from January 1, 2025 to the present.

Specifically, I request the following categories of records:

1. System descriptions, concept of operations documents, or equivalent materials that describe what VOWS is and how it is used by USCIS personnel.
2. Privacy Impact Assessments, System of Records Notices, or internal privacy or civil liberties assessments specific to VOWS.
3. Policies, guidance, or standard operating procedures governing reliance on VOWS outputs in adjudicative or investigative decision-making.

This request does not seek source code, algorithms, model weights, or sensitive technical vulnerabilities. If any portion of the requested records is exempt from disclosure, please release all reasonably segregable non-exempt material.

Fee Waiver Request

I request a waiver of all search, review, and duplication fees pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(4)(A) (iii). Disclosure of the requested information is in the public interest because it is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of the operations and activities of the government and is not primarily in my commercial interest.

The requested records concern the use of an automated or data-driven vetting tool in immigration adjudications, an area implicating due process, privacy, and civil liberties. There is substantial public interest in understanding how such tools are deployed, what safeguards govern their use, and the extent to which their outputs may influence government decision-making.

Disclosure of these records will contribute meaningfully to public understanding by shedding light on USCIS's policies and practices regarding algorithmic or analytic systems used in marriage-based immigration contexts—information that is not otherwise publicly available in sufficient detail. I intend to analyze and disseminate any information received through reporting and public-interest research, making the results available to a broad audience.

I have no commercial interest in the requested information.

If you determine that a fee waiver is not appropriate, please notify me in advance if estimated fees are expected to exceed \$25.

If you have any questions regarding this request or believe it can be further narrowed to expedite processing, please contact me.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Michael Wriston